

# Trust and Safety Intention Document

Title suggested by the professor:

*Speaking in Code: Automated Detection of Dogwhistle Language and Covert Hate Speech on Reddit*

| Rubric Item                                        | Subitem                                   | Variants                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Score | Comment                                               |
|----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Clarity, Structure and Presentation (20pts)</b> | <b>Logic &amp; Narrative Flow (8 pts)</b> | <b>7-8 pts: Seamless Narrative.</b> The document flows perfectly from the problem statement to the methodology. Every section builds on the previous one without any mental leaps required by the reader. | 8     | Excellent logical progression and narrative coherence |
|                                                    |                                           | <b>5-6 pts: Logical Flow.</b> The document is organized and mostly clear, with only minor issues in transition between sections.                                                                          |       |                                                       |
|                                                    |                                           | <b>3-4 pts: Disjointed Logic.</b> Writing is occasionally unclear or disjointed. The connection between the audit goal and the method is weak.                                                            |       |                                                       |
|                                                    |                                           | <b>1-2 pts: Header-Only Structure.</b> The document uses the template but feels like a list of unrelated thoughts rather than a coherent plan.                                                            |       |                                                       |
|                                                    |                                           | <b>0 pts: Incoherent.</b> Poor organization and significant formatting issues make the document difficult to follow.                                                                                      |       |                                                       |
|                                                    | <b>Technical</b>                          | <b>5-6 pts: Industry Standard.</b> Uses professional Trust & Safety terminology (e.g., "adversarial                                                                                                       | 6     | Outstanding use of                                    |

|  |                                                      |                                                                                                                                         |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
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|  | <b>Precision (6 pts)</b>                             | testing," "false positives," "harms-based approach") correctly and naturally.                                                           |   | technical terminology deployed correctly throughout. The distinction between "conventionalization," "abandonment," and "repurposing" of hate speech terms shows especially good conceptual precision.                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|  |                                                      | <b>3-4 pts:</b> Developing Precision. Mentions some technical terms but occasionally uses them vaguely or incorrectly.                  |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|  |                                                      | <b>0-2 pts:</b> Non-Technical. Uses colloquial language (e.g., "bad stuff on the web") rather than academic or industry-standard terms. |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|  | <b>Conciseness &amp; Information Density (6 pts)</b> | <b>5-6 pts:</b> High Density. Writing is concise and "polished," with every sentence providing new, necessary information.              | 5 | Very high information density with minimal redundancy. Nearly every sentence provides substantive information. The proposal is well-edited and economical.<br><br>Minor point: The T&S connections section (Section 3) becomes slightly verbose when discussing upcoming course themes—the paragraphs on red teaming and cross-cultural populations could be more concise since these are |
|  |                                                      | <b>3-4 pts:</b> Wordy. Contains "fluff" or repetitive statements that do not add value to the audit plan.                               |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|  |                                                      | <b>0-2 pts:</b> Word Salad. Writing is either so brief it lacks meaning or so repetitive that the core plan is lost.                    |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

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|                                                     |                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                       |   | forward-looking rather than substantive methodological connections.                                                                         |
| <b>Relevance to Trust and Safety Themes (15pts)</b> | <b>Framework Integration (8 Marks)</b>              | <b>5-8 pts: Expert Integration.</b> Specifically applies multiple course themes or frameworks (e.g., The Santa Clara Principles) to the audit's design.                               | 8 | Exceptional integration of course materials and T&S frameworks. You explicitly reference and meaningfully engage with FIVE course readings. |
|                                                     |                                                     | <b>3-4 pts: Surface Engagement.</b> Mentions course concepts, but the connection to the audit feels tacked-on or vague.                                                               |   |                                                                                                                                             |
|                                                     |                                                     | <b>0-2 pts: No Connection.</b> Lacks any meaningful link to Trust & Safety course content.                                                                                            |   |                                                                                                                                             |
|                                                     | <b>Conceptual Depth &amp; Nuance (7 Marks)</b>      | <b>6-7 pts: Deep Understanding.</b> Demonstrates a nuanced understanding of T&S trade-offs, such as safety vs. privacy or automation vs. human review.                                | 7 | Sophisticated demonstration of nuanced understanding across multiple dimensions.                                                            |
|                                                     |                                                     | <b>3-5 pts: Basic Understanding.</b> Mentions a concept but treats it as a binary or simple issue.                                                                                    |   |                                                                                                                                             |
|                                                     |                                                     | <b>0-2 pts: Missing.</b> Does not address the complexities of the chosen T&S theme.                                                                                                   |   |                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Project Summary (15pts)</b>                      | <b>Problem &amp; Stakeholder Precision (10 pts)</b> | <b>8-10 pts: Surgical Precision.</b> Identifies a "clearly scoped" problem, specific "affected stakeholders," and precise "harms" (e.g., "financial exploitation of elderly users via | 9 | Excellent problem framing: clear articulation of the detection gap                                                                          |

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|                         |                                               | AI-generated voice cloning").                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |    | <p>between covert hate speech (dogwhistles, leetspeak, coded language) and automated moderation tools.</p> <p>Minor area for strengthening: Could quantify the scale of covert hate speech prevalence or cite specific incidents/cases where detection failures enabled harm. The conceptual framing is strong; additional empirical evidence of urgency would make it even stronger.</p> |
|                         |                                               | <b>4-7 pts: Generic Problem.</b> The problem is too broad (e.g., "stopping hate speech") or stakeholders are generic (e.g., "all users").                                                                                                                                                                           |    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|                         |                                               | <b>0-3 pts: Missing.</b> Problem articulation is unrelated to Trust & Safety or is entirely absent.                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|                         | <b>Motivation (5 Marks)</b>                   | <p><b>3-5 pts: Strong Motivation.</b> Offers a compelling rationale for why this audit is necessary now.</p> <p><b>1-2 pts: Weak Motivation.</b> Explains the project but fails to justify its urgency or importance.</p> <p><b>0 pts: No Motivation.</b> Does not explain why the project is being undertaken.</p> | 5  | Compelling, well-justified motivation. The motivation is clear, timely, and grounded in both academic literature and practical impact.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Feasibility & Methodolo | <b>Audit Mechanics &amp; Rigor (12 Marks)</b> | <b>11-12 pts: Detailed &amp; Rigorous.</b> Provides a step-by-step, scientific plan for measurement.                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 12 | Outstanding methodological detail                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |

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| Methodological Soundness |                                             | It includes specific variables, controls, or testing criteria.                                                                                                             |   | and rigor. Your three-component design is sophisticated and well-specified                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|                          |                                             | <b>7-10 pts: Sound but Thin.</b> A clear plan exists, but it has "minor methodological issues" or lacks a specific control group.                                          |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|                          |                                             | <b>3-6 pts: Vague.</b> The plan lacks specificity; it is unclear how the data will actually be measured.                                                                   |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|                          |                                             | <b>0-2 pts: Implausible.</b> The plan is incoherent, technically impossible, or absent.                                                                                    |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|                          | <b>Data Access &amp; Strategy (7 Marks)</b> | <b>5-7 pts: Confirmed Access.</b> Identifies specific, realistic data sources (e.g., "TikTok Research API," "public transparency reports") and proves they are accessible. | 6 | Excellent data access strategy with confirmed, documented approach.<br><br>Small area for improvement: While the sampling strategy is sound in principle, I would benefit from seeing candidate subreddit examples or selection criteria beyond "politically polarized." Otherwise, this is very well-documented. |
|                          |                                             | <b>3-4 pts: Unclear Strategy.</b> Mentions data but lacks a plan for how to obtain it or assumes access to private platform data.                                          |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|                          |                                             | <b>0-2 pts: No Data Plan.</b> Does not mention what data will be used.                                                                                                     |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|                          | Timeline & Feasibility (6                   | <b>5-6 pts: Realistic Timeline.</b> Provides a phase-by-phase schedule that is "clearly                                                                                    | 5 | Problem is well scoped.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

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|                                                                              | Marks)                        | achievable" within the semester.                                                                                                                                     |   | However, you might want to think about an explicit week-by-week timeline. A timeline would demonstrate these stages fit within ~10 weeks and show where parallel work is possible (e.g., Taaha building pipeline while Amory collects data while Mohamed curates lexicon). |
|                                                                              |                               | <b>3-4 pts: Ambitious/Unlikely.</b> The timeline is mentioned but seems too condensed or ignores the time needed for data cleaning/analysis.                         |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|                                                                              |                               | <b>0-2 pts: Missing.</b> No discussion of how the project will be completed on time.                                                                                 |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Anticipated Challenges or Risks (15pts)<br>Expected Outcomes Group Formation | Risk Identification (7 Marks) | <b>5-7 pts: Multi-faceted Risks.</b> Identifies "multiple credible risks" including ethical dilemmas (e.g., user privacy) and technical barriers (e.g., API limits). | 7 | Comprehensive, thoughtful risk identification across five dimensions                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|                                                                              |                               | <b>3-4 pts: General Risks.</b> Mentions only surface-level risks like "running out of time".                                                                         |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|                                                                              |                               | <b>0-2 pts: No Recognition.</b> No discussion of challenges or risks.                                                                                                |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|                                                                              | Mitigation Strategy (8 Marks) | <b>7-8 pts: Thoughtful Mitigation.</b> Offers specific, actionable plans to address each identified risk.                                                            | 7 | Strong mitigation strategies for most identified risks.                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|                                                                              |                               | <b>4-6 pts: Partial Mitigation.</b> Offers a plan for one risk but ignores others.                                                                                   |   | Minor gap: No mention of inter-rater reliability                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

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|                           |  | <b>0-3 pts: No Plan.</b> Identifies risks but provides no strategy to solve them.                                                     |   | measurement despite having two-dimensional annotation (hate type + evasion strategy). Will you calculate Cohen's kappa or Krippendorff's alpha? What threshold constitutes acceptable agreement? What's the process for resolving disagreements? This would strengthen the mitigation section. |
| Expected Outcomes (10pts) |  | <b>8-10 pts: Measurable &amp; Aligned.</b> Outcomes are "specific, measurable," and align perfectly with the methods and course goals | 9 | <p>Clear, well-articulated outcomes aligned with methodology.</p> <p>Area for strengthening: You mention "technical interventions and policy considerations" but don't preview what these might look like. Will you recommend platforms that integrate</p>                                     |
|                           |  | <b>3-7 pts: Generic Outcomes.</b> Outcomes are described but are vague (e.g., "we will learn a lot").                                 |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|                           |  | <b>0-2 pts: Missing.</b> Outcomes are unrealistic or absent.                                                                          |   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

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|  |  |  |  | lexicon-based preprocessing?<br>Suggest human-in-the-loop for borderline cases?<br>Propose specific API improvements? |
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Total: 91